

Segment 26 Unnamed Road to East of McCormick

(Formerly Segment 23), Updated April 26. [Google Map of Segment 26](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

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Segment length: About 4.25 miles, east to west 514 ft of ascent, 414 ft descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 36 in Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact mac@northcountrytrail.org or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)

As you exit the unnamed gravel road following the blazes at (46.661011,-87.898302), this segment traverses private land and has several eye-catching features. The trail is mostly hardwood forests with lots of undulations. In the first third of the segment, a small unnamed lake comes into view along the north side of the trail, providing several nice spots to rest and enjoy the sights and sounds. In the western third of this segment along the Dead River, you will come upon a small gorge at the bottom of a small cascading rock waterfall. At the top of the falls is the Boy Scout Bridge, another great place to take a break and absorb nature. You will come out on a two track, turn right, and following the blazes, walk about 500 feet before again turning west to continue to the end of this segment (46.653563,-87.957707). This segment ends just before entering the McCormick Wilderness.

Driving Directions

Eastern Trailhead:

From the traffic circle by the Meijer Gas Station in Marquette, take US-41 west for 28 miles through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [*County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade*] for 4.1 miles. Turn right and follow Dishno Rd. for approximately 1.6 miles. Stay left onto an unnamed gravel road (turning off of Dishno Rd, which turns right at this point). Follow this road (which may be labeled Wildcat Creek Rd on some maps) for about 6 miles. This may be labeled Carlson's Corner, and there is a large rock in the middle of the intersection. Turn right and follow this next unnamed road for about 3.3 miles where the trail crosses. You will cross the Dead River about .5 mile before reaching the trail. Parking is just past the trail crossing. For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving map from US 41 to Unnamed Rd Parking.](#)

Western Trailhead:

From the traffic circle by the Meijer Gas Station in Marquette, take US-41 west for 28 miles through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [*County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade*] for 4.1 miles. Turn right and follow Dishno Rd. for approximately 1.6 miles. Stay left onto an unnamed gravel road (turning off of Dishno Rd, which turns right at this point). Follow this road (which may be labeled Wildcat Creek Rd on some maps) for about 6 miles. This may be labeled Carlson's Corner, and there is a large rock in the middle of the intersection. Turn left. Go to the fork at 0.7 mile and stay left. You will come to a red gate that is closed but unlocked. You may go through but be sure to close the gate each time you go through it to respect the property owners who have so kindly given us permission to pass through. Go about a mile from the fork and park. For those who prefer to follow. Google Map, here is the [Driving Map from US 41 to parking for East McCormick](#)

Camping:

This is mostly private property but the owners allow dispersed camping. Some of this segment is also commercial forest land where dispersed camping is allowed.

Water Access:

There are several water access points at water crossings.

Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring to early winter, a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach either trailhead. Trailheads are not reachable via vehicle in the wintertime.